

Received by the Department on the following date (fill in):

FORM FOR ADJUDICATION COMMITTEE FOR PHD DISPUTATION

Proposed by: *Anthony Mathelier*

NB! The form must be signed by the proposer before it is sent to the Faculty!

Ieva Rauluseviciute has handed in the dissertation *Computational Approaches to Exploring Transcription Factor-DNA Interactions: From Resource Development to Co-binding Prediction* for assessment for the degree of *Philosophiae Doctor* at the Faculty of Mathematics and Natural Sciences.

Type of dissertation: ☒ Articles ☐ Monograph

The disputation is scheduled for: end of September (to be decided by the committee)

To assess the dissertation, a committee of the following opponents is hereby proposed:

Opponent 1:

Name: *Bruno Contreras Moreira*
Title and degree: *Head scientist*
Gender: *Male*
Affiliated work place (institution): *Departamento de genética y producción vegetal, Estacion Experimental de Aula Dei, Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas*
Work place address: *Av Montañana 1005, 50059 Zaragoza, Spain*
E-mail: *bcontreras@eead.csic.es*
Telephone: *+34976716089*

Opponent 2:

Name: *Anagha Madhusudan Joshi-Michael*
Title and degree: *Professor*
Gender: *Female*
Affiliated work place (institution): *Department of Clinical Science, University of Bergen*
Work place address: *Haukeland universitetssykehus, Laboratoriebygget 5009 Bergen*
E-mail: *anagha.joshi@uib.no*
Telephone: *+4755584149*

Opponent 3 (administrator):

Name: *Trine Ballestad Rounge*
Title and degree: *Professor*
Gender: *Female*
Affiliated work place (institution): *Section for Pharmacology and Pharmaceutical Biosciences, Centre for Bioinformatics, The Faculty of Mathematics and Natural Sciences, University of Oslo*
Work place address: *Gaustadalléen 30, N-0373 Oslo*
E-mail: *t.b.rounge@farmasi.uio.no*
Telephone: *+4722844948*

The assessment committee should ideally be comprised of members of both genders and at least one member must come from an institution abroad. If the proposal does not comply with these regulations, the reason/s for this must be stated below. The statement should also explain how the committee collectively covers the academic field of the dissertation.

Reason/s for the adjudication committee not comprising members of both genders and/or lacking foreign committee members: N/A

Grounds for choice of committee members (*Short description of scientific qualifications and reasons for why the member in question is suited for the role as an opponent*):

Opponent 1

Bruno Contreras Moreira has an extensive research background and expertise in computational biology, particularly in the context of TF-DNA interactions and regulatory genomics. His work includes significant contributions to understanding the structural and functional aspects of transcription factors and their interactions with DNA, as exemplified by his work on the Regulatory Sequence Analysis Tools (RSAT), and protein-DNA complex modeling. His expertise aligns closely with the PhD thesis topic, ensuring that his insights and evaluations will be highly relevant and beneficial. Dr. Contreras Moreira represents an international expert in the field.

Opponent 2

Anagha Joshi is an expert in computational biology, with a particular focus on epigenetics and transcriptional regulation. As a Professor at the Computational Biology Unit, University of Bergen, and through her previous positions, she has led significant research projects that align closely with the thesis topic. Her work includes comprehensive analyses of epigenetic signatures and their impact on transcription control, utilizing multi-omics data to explore epigenetic modifications and transcription features. Her expertise will offer valuable perspectives and thorough assessment of the computational techniques and biological insights presented in the thesis. Dr. Joshi will act as an internal expert with current employment in Norway.

Opponent 3

Trine Rounge is an expert in computational biology / bioinformatics with relevant work on the analysis of genomics data. Her expertise makes her a good candidate as the administrator of the adjudication committee.

All 3 opponents must fill in and sign the declaration of neutrality. The 3 declarations must be enclosed with this form when sent to the Faculty.

The Faculty will inform the Department about the appointment, and the Department informs the student and the members of the adjudication committee and also ensures that the members are sent a copy of the dissertation and governing regulations. The committee will be informed about the deadline for assessment.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be a stylized 'M' or 'W' with a horizontal line extending to the right.

June 17th, 2024

Date and signature, proposer